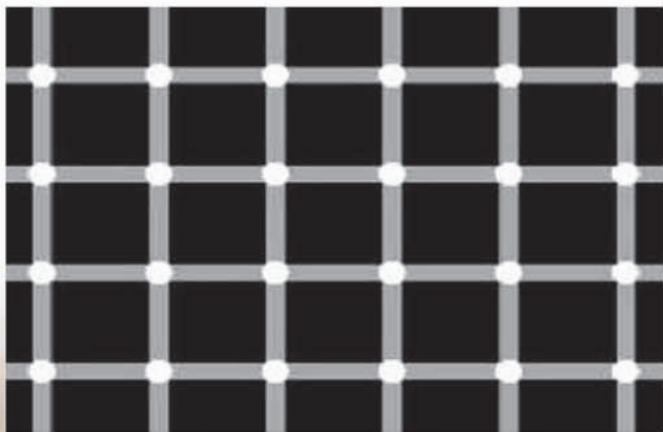


SEEING SPOTS

When you look at this grid, dark spots seem to flash within the white spots at the corner of each square. Scientists still don't know why this happens, although it probably has something to do with the optical cells in your eyes switching on and off. Oddly, tilting your head to one side seems to reduce the effect of the illusion.



IMPOSSIBLE OBJECT

This triangle looks like a solid, three-dimensional (3-D) object, even though such an object could not exist. The illusion works because each corner of the triangle follows the optical rules that your brain uses to identify 3-D shapes, so it insists on making the pattern represent a 3-D object. The shape is called the Penrose triangle after its creator, mathematician Roger Penrose.



DOUBLE IMAGE

What does this picture look like to you? Some people see a white vase against a darker background, while others see two people facing each other. Now that you've read this, you can probably see both images. Your brain uses information stored in your memory to interpret confusing images, and sometimes it comes up with two conflicting solutions at once.

